

18.7 KEY LANGUAGE MODIFYING WORDS

"Quite," "really," and "absolutely" can be used to modify how much you like or don't like something. These modifying words must go before the verb.

In UK English "quite" doesn't have as strong an emphasis as "really." In US English the emphasis is stronger.

"Really" is used when you mean "a lot more."

"Absolutely" is used in extreme forms.

I **quite** enjoy cycling.

You can use "quite" before "enjoy" and "like."



I **really** like cycling.

You can use "really" before "like," "love," "enjoy," "don't like," and "hate."



I **absolutely** love cycling.

You can use "absolutely" before "love" and "hate."



18.8 FURTHER EXAMPLES MODIFYING WORDS



He **quite** likes playing tennis.



I **really** don't like cooking.



He **really** loves eating cake.



She **really** hates waking up early.



She **really** enjoys playing guitar.



They **absolutely** hate singing.



18.9 ⚠ COMMON MISTAKES

Some combinations of modifying words and verbs are wrong.

I **quite** love cycling. ❌

Don't use "quite" before "love," "don't like," or "hate."

I **absolutely** enjoy cycling. ❌

Don't use "absolutely" before "like," "enjoy," or "don't like."



18.10 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORD IN EACH SENTENCE

I ~~quite~~ / **really** love going to the movie theater.

① I **absolutely** / ~~quite~~ hate traveling to the city.

② I **really** / ~~absolutely~~ enjoy reading books.

③ I **absolutely** / ~~quite~~ like swimming.

④ I **quite** / **really** hate driving to work.

